

Who Is the Greatest in the Kingdom of God

Meditation Follows the Method of Extracting Revelation, Not Just the Revelation Itself

I want you to remember this: we are studying more the method of extracting revelation knowledge than we are the revelation knowledge itself. The method of extracting it. Thank You, Jesus.

Matthew 18. We will begin with the first verse.

In these particular kinds of messages, you will have to hang in very close with me, because as we study these laws that govern the meditation of His Word, one verse will breed the meaning of the next, and the next, and the next, and so on. In other words, one set of verses will not make any sense to you, and they probably never have. But the reason they are not making any sense is because you did not understand the set of verses before it.

We demonstrated some of that last night, just briefly. But today we get to study the actual method.

In Psalm 1, which you do not have to go to, and which we will be quoting frequently in these teaching sessions, it says:

Blessed is the man that walketh not in the counsel of the ungodly, nor standeth in the way of sinners.

Analyzing that briefly, if there is anything on God's green earth that Dave Roberson wants to be, it is a blessed man of God. I do not care if denominations call me blessed or people call me blessed. What I am concerned with is if I am a blessed man of God, if His evidence is in my life.

What qualifies me to be that blessed man? Number one, he walks not in the counsel of the ungodly. He does not receive his counsel from the world. Number two, he stands not in the way of sinners, or he does not do things the way sinners do. Nor does he sit in the seat of the scornful.

If I am not going to take my counsel from the world, if I am not going to do things the way sinners do, then I had better take this one step further, which is Psalm 1:2. His delight is in the law, in the Word of God, and in that Word he meditates day and night.

What is the purpose of this meditation? It is not so I can out-quote more verses than Gordon, and not so I can appear to be so intellectual. The purpose of meditation is to extract the counsel from the Word of God so I do not have to take my counsel from the world or stand in the way of sinners, but have counsel from the Word to walk by.

Therefore, in a quick analysis this round, what is meditation? It is not memorization, although memorization will assist your meditation. It is not study, although study will assist your meditation. Meditation is not reading, although reading will assist your meditation.

Meditation is when you allow the Holy Spirit to get involved with your spirit in such a way that He actually takes the counsel that left the heart of God in the form of the Word and reconstructs it in your heart, so that it becomes the understanding counsel you and I need to walk by, counsel that liberates us from the counsel of the world.

Hallelujah.

Meditation is when you allow the Spirit to get involved with you in such a way that you can actually extract the counsel that left the heart of God in the form of the Word. Jesus said:

My words, they are spirit, and they are life.

Jesus Teaches Whole Subjects, While Doctrines of Flesh Fragment the Word

I am going to give you the number one rule of Jesus Christ, for I have patterned my teachings and my studies after the Master Teacher Himself. I have found no better Teacher in all the writings of the world than Jesus Christ.

He said, "What I hear My Father say, that I say." Would to God I was that yielded. He said, "What I hear My Father say, that I say, and what I see My Father do, that I do."

Part of what He saw His Father do was through the imagery of the Old Testament. Part of what we see our Father do is through the imagery of the New Testament. That is part of it. The other part is the gifts of the Spirit.

We have no trouble believing that Jesus Christ was the Master Teacher, the greatest Teacher who ever lived, totally yielded to the Spirit.

In studying His method of teaching in detail, because I wanted to pattern myself after Him, I figured if I was going to teach His stuff, the best thing to do was teach like Him. You do not mind if I copy His teachings, do you?

Then I found out this number one rule about Jesus Christ: He always taught in total and entire subjects. To write that down, you would say He never took a verse out of context. Ever.

Jesus always taught in total and entire subjects. He never went on to the next subject until He completely finished the one He was on.

We are the ones guilty of that. Us preachers will conceive some doctrine in our thinking, and then we search the Word of God to get scattered verses to prove our theology. In doing so, we create doctrines of flesh, and they destroy us. It is as simple as that. He said if you walk after the flesh, you will die, but if you walk after the Spirit, it will bring forth life.

Oh, I like that.

For instance, one of everybody's favorites is Romans 8:28:

We know that all things work together for good to them that love God, to them who are the called according to His purpose.

What things, preacher?

They are so faithful to name almost every damnable thing we have been delivered from: correction, diseases, persecutions. "They are all working for our good."

But if you get the context of the chapter, he is saying for the man who walks in the Spirit and makes intercession, God is turning everything into the purpose and plan of God. Therefore, anything contrary to God's purpose in your life, God will arrest it. That which was meant for evil, God will turn the table on the devil and make it good.

I like the way I found this out serving Him. He is a whole lot smarter than the devil. It did not take me long to figure that out, just as soon as I quit accusing God for what the devil was doing.

Jesus always taught in total and entire subjects. When He was contending with the Pharisees and shutting their mouths, that was one thing. But when He was teaching, it was another story.

If Jesus was teaching at this pulpit, He would begin at the top, using the energy and mastery of words. By the time He reached the bottom, in your spirit He would have painted a perfect picture of this pulpit. That means every verse is a thought within itself. Every Scripture is a stroke of the brush, but invariably it is always building toward the completion of the entire picture.

We have made the job of the Holy Spirit so difficult. With the fast pace of life you live now, it is hard enough for Him to get anything over to you.

"I do not believe that."

Okay, how many bad decisions have you made this last year?

It is hard for Him to get anything over to you. The leadership of the Spirit is a little more delicate than I thought, but much more available than I thought. I love it. I love to teach on it, holler about it, and bask in it.

"Where do you get your stuff?"

This is how. This is where I get it.

As we progress further into this, we will get into the Spirit's involvement more and more, but right now we are just looking at principles.

The way we make it so difficult on the Holy Spirit is that we lift one verse out of its text, out of its context, and say, "I am just going to meditate on this one." You are making the Spirit's job hard, because you are asking Him to do a miracle. You are asking Him to paint the whole picture around it.

If you can learn through meditation to first paint the outline, the bulk of the picture through the subject, then you make it much easier for Him to put the final touches on the difficult part of the revelation.

I have found that the first thing the Spirit will alert me to is the beginning of a subject and the end of a subject. I will be reading along in the Bible, and He will alert me to the beginning of the subject, and then He will alert me to the end of the subject.

When I find the beginning and the end, sometimes I will read what is in between, whether it is two chapters or three, without breaking pace, a hundred or two hundred times, not trying to get anything out of it. The reason is that I am allowing the Holy Spirit to first formulate the entire image of the subject, and then I start going after the verses.

How are you doing? Feel like you are in Bible college?

What is going to be different about this chapter? Nothing. What is going to be different is what we do with it, the way we break it.

I could read from verse one clear to the end of this entire chapter, but I am not going to do it. I am going to start picking on individual verses because you have the concept.

Are you ready?

Greatness in the Kingdom Is High Authority Gained Through Servitude

Let us begin with the first verse. Oh, this is going to be fun. There is nothing I love more except stomping the devil, casting him out, getting people healed, and things like that. Other than that, I love meditation. Through meditation, I learned who I was.

Have you ever gone out looking for a fight?

Hallelujah.

Matthew 18:1:

At the same time came the disciples unto Jesus, saying, Who is the greatest in the kingdom of heaven?

After meditating much on this statement, you have heard messages on greatness in the kingdom of God, and it does not take very much to know that Jesus stated, "He that is servant of all will be greatest among you." He will be greatest in the kingdom of God.

But what does He mean by the servitude He is talking about? "He that is servant of all, be your minister." He will be greatest in the kingdom of God.

I said, "What does He mean?" They are asking Him who is the greatest in His kingdom, and He said, "The servant."

I used to think in my carnality that being a servant meant you could go ahead and do anything you wanted to me, and I would still serve. Walk on my back, jump on me, be mean to me, use me as a doormat, and I will still serve God because He loves me. That is greatest in the kingdom of God. I am supposed to wash your socks or something.

I used to think that was what servant, the greatest in the kingdom of God, meant. But it does not.

When the mother of the sons of Zebedee came to Jesus seeking high-ranking positions in the kingdom of God for her sons, at His left and right hands, He said, "You have asked a hard thing." He went on to say a few things, but then He said the Gentiles exercise dominion and authority over each other by force.

In other words, "I have decided to be king, and I am going to take it away from you. If you do not like it, I will execute dominion and force over you." They get their position by authority, by force.

But He says among you, it shall not be so. Authority in the kingdom of God, greatness in the kingdom of God, is obtained by servitude. He said, "You asked Me for high-ranking positions of authority. Let Me tell you how authority comes in the kingdom of God. He that is greatest among you will be servant of all."

That is how you get high-ranking authority.

Then it dawned on me what kind of servitude He was talking about. It is not the "wash your socks, iron your shirt" kind. It is the kind of high-ranking authority that comes through the rights of the believer, so that when the world comes looking for an answer, you can serve the world from the table of Jesus Christ that was prepared for them by God.

You can point your finger in the face of leprosy and serve them healing. That is the purest kind of servitude in His kingdom, and brother, that is high-ranking authority. The only way you get it is through serving.

So they asked Him, "Who is greatest in the kingdom of God? How do you get this high-ranking authority?"

He said, "The greatest in the kingdom of God is servant of all."

I am not going to lie to you. I want to go all the way with God. I want to cut a swath a yard deep, a mile wide, and rip it all the way around the world, and take several million home to be with Jesus.

Am I asking too much? Of course not.

So I paid very close attention to this first verse, because they would not ask Him a question like this without Him going on to answer it. His answer will be how to get this high-ranking authority through servitude.

I know you want to go as far as you can go in Jesus too. Through meditation, my God, I found out He is going to tell them how to get there.

This stuff becomes better than watching television.

A Little Child Reveals Trust, Forgiveness, and Complete Teachability

In the second verse, you might know Jesus would do something like this:

And Jesus called a little child unto Him, and set him in the midst of them, And said, Verily I say unto you, Except ye be converted, and become as little children, ye shall not enter into the kingdom of heaven. Whosoever therefore shall humble himself as this little child, the same is greatest in the kingdom of heaven.

When I found out that this greatness was a high-ranking authority position in the kingdom to execute the power from the table of Jesus Christ, and when I found out He used a little child as an example and said that I must become as a little child, then do you not think I studied our kids for the first time?

I did a major study on our kids. If you are like me, I am very exhaustive. I ask people who are knowledgeable. I get my Greek interlinears, my outerlinears, my exteriors, my interiors, my Wuest, and Strong's. This is after I have already done the whole chapter hundreds of times. Now I am starting to break it down to the nitty-gritty. Any verse that has tinges and no understanding, I will get every translation, everything. I want the image in the chapter because I want the faith in it.

Is it worth it? You ought to see what this stuff produces. Airplanes. Buildings.

I started doing the study on a little child. I watched our kids, just like I did on mustard seed faith, and I started noticing things about them.

When I asked these pastors and knowledgeable people, "What does it mean to become as a little child?" they all had almost a different answer. The most common answer I received was, "A little child is all trusting."

That is true. A little child is basically all trusting.

But in the light of this chapter, God added one more attribute to a child, even more so than all trusting: a little child is very, very quick to forgive.

Some of you have gotten into fights with your neighbors because your kids got into fights with the neighbor kids. They clubbed each other in the head with a toy. They ran home screaming, "Mama!" Then you called, went over, and got into it with each other.

Pretty soon the kids were bawling that afternoon to go back and play.

"I want to go play with Jimmy again."

"No, because we are going to fight for a year."

Come on. A higher attribute of a child even than all trusting is that he is very quick to forgive. Little kids will fight like cats and dogs and then can hardly wait to see their little friend again.

But in my meditations, He added one more attribute, every bit as powerful as quick to forgive: a tiny child is one thousand percent teachable. Teachable.

In fact, when you add trusting to teachable, he is at your mercy.

Hallelujah.

A little child is totally teachable. That explains why this verse said what it did. "Except ye be converted," number one, be born again, and, number two, become as little children, "ye shall not enter into the kingdom of heaven."

The reason He said converted first and become as a little child second is because when a man is converted, when a man is born again, the rebirth is synonymous with the natural birth. When you were born in the natural, you were totally trusting, totally dependent, and totally teachable on your mother and father. You could not even feed yourself.

You would eat anything they gave you, and it has been proven. Some mothers have put strychnine in their baby's milk to get rid of them or stuck pins in their heads. A child is not only at your mercy; he has to trust you.

The spiritual birth is synonymous with the natural birth. When you are born in the natural, you are totally helpless. You have to be taught and dressed. Pretty soon you start learning how to do things for yourself.

They can tell you, "Son, the moon is actually made out of cheese," and you would not find out any different until you went to school, because you trusted them.

So in the spirit, it is no different. When you are born again, you come into the spiritual world as a straddling youngster. That is why He gave you the Holy Spirit as your Teacher, to guide you into all truth.

That is why in the body, when you are little bitty ones, He gave you teachers to mature you to a degree until you fill your own office, until you begin to teach, or begin to learn, or start fulfilling yours as equal with your teachers, or always learning and filling another office.

When you come into the spiritual world as a straddling youngster, you are at the mercy of your teachers. You have the Holy Spirit. Many of you are baptized and run around speaking with tongues. I did.

Then your teacher stands up and says, "God gave me a car wreck so I could buy a car from the insurance settlement."

And you go, "Yeah, glory to God. Who can know the mystery of God?"

We all yell, "Glory to God," and there you are, a tongue-talking, Holy Ghost-filled, new creation, born-again Christian, eating junk food.

Do not tell me you do not do it. How many of you ever believed something you found out was not true?

I hear a loud amen over here, but I think it is directed at other people.

What happens? They feed us anything, and we just eat it and run around full of the Holy Ghost, not listening to our Teacher.

Receiving a Little One Is Receiving Jesus Himself

This is why the next verses in the progression of meditation say what they say. Watch closely:

Whosoever therefore shall humble himself as this little child, the same is greatest in the kingdom of heaven. And whoso shall receive one such little child in My name receiveth Me. But whoso shall offend one of these little ones which believe in Me, it were better for him that a millstone were hanged about his neck, and that he were drowned in the depth of the sea.

Now you tell me, which one are you? Are you the one receiving the little child, or are you the little child being received? Which one are you?

If you are not in the Spirit and in meditation here, you would not catch the transition. Somewhere in our growth, He expects us to go from the little one to one who receives the straddling little ones who have come into the kingdom of God.

This gets really heavy, because He puts so much priority on these little, totally-at-your-mercy, teachable ones. He says, "Whoso receives one of these little ones in My name," I want you to know you have received Me.

If Jesus came through that back door and said, "Would one of you ladies please get Me a glass of water? I am weary from My journey," it would take Pastor Gordon two hours to pry you out of the doorway. You would all want to do something for the Man who bore your sins and took your place.

God knows I would do anything for Him. Absolutely anything. It would not take Him half an hour to finish getting the last of you out of the doorway, because all of you would want to go get Him a glass of water. There would not be any hesitation to receive Jesus and do anything He wanted if you knew He actually came walking in here.

Yet take a drunken, rejected, beat-up, wilted, dirty, creased wino who wants to receive Jesus and see how you treat him. Come on. Go back there and treat him like you would Jesus. Then let us sing our song, "Oh, how I love Jesus." Let us be real.

Why do we not give a whole lot of money and build up a place where we can put transients to recover? Why do we not include that on our curriculum?

I did not say it. Jesus did. He said, "Whosoever receives one of these little ones in My name," one of these little hungry ones for God, "the way you treat him, you are treating Me."

Have you ever gotten that in your spirit?

On the other side of the coin, He says whoever receives one of these little ones and offends him has offended Me.

Offending Little Ones Means Placing False Light Before the Teachable

In the light of what a little one is, how in the world would I offend him? A little one is quick to forgive, and a little one is one thousand percent teachable and trusting. So how would I offend him?

The way I would offend a little one is to put a stumbling block in his way. The word breaks down in the Greek as a continual block. In other words, it is such a stumbling block that it causes him to stumble and fall, a stumbling block he almost cannot recover from.

I kept thinking, "If a little one is so quick to forgive, what facet of the nature of a little one do I put the stumbling block in front of?"

The Lord said, "Because he is one hundred percent teachable, the way they cause him to fall is by putting stumbling blocks in front of him: truths that are not truths, light that is not light, that binds him in a doctrine of flesh and strips him of any reward or victories he might have had in God."

When I have made the transition from being a little one to receiving a little one, He said if I offend, if I put a stumbling block in front of a little one who is totally teachable, then I have offended Jesus.

So you are sitting here thinking, "I can go to any church I want. I can listen to any doctrine I want. They do not want to preach being filled with the Holy Ghost. Who cares? I will just bring people anyway."

Go ahead and bring the little one with you. If you bind him for life, you have offended Jesus.

What is this dealing with?

Look a little further. The fifth verse says:

Whoso shall receive one such little child in My name receiveth Me. But whoso shall offend one of these little ones which believe in Me, it were better for him that a millstone were hanged about his neck, and that he were drowned in the depth of the sea.

Woe unto the world because of offences! for it must needs be that offences come; but woe to that man by whom the offence cometh!

Then He says:

Wherefore if thy hand or thy foot offend thee, cut them off, and cast them from thee: it is better for thee to enter into life halt or maimed, rather than having two hands or two feet to be cast into everlasting fire. And if thine eye offend thee, pluck it out, and cast it from thee: it is better for thee to enter into life with one eye, rather than having two eyes to be cast into hell fire. Take heed that ye despise not one of these little ones; for I say unto you, That in heaven their angels do always behold the face of My Father which is in heaven.

In other words, these little ones are always standing in His presence.

This is heavy.

He said, "Woe unto the world because of offenses." What kind of offenses? The kind that puts a stumbling block in front of these little ones that they have trouble recovering from.

Then He says, "Wherefore," or based on what I have already said, if your hand or your foot offends you, cut it off.

In the laws of meditation, when you see the word therefore or wherefore, you had better see what it is there for.

We know, according to the Word of God in context, that He is not talking about cutting your literal hand off or plucking your literal eye out. That would be defiling and maiming this temple God has given me to serve Him in. So He could not be talking about that.

But He used such major imagery here because He was talking about something that would hurt every bit as much whenever you and I start dealing with the flesh and the nature of it in the realm of forgiveness and humility, which is totally teachable. My God, that hurts. There is nothing that hurts more in this whole life than dealing with the flesh.

That is why He says, "If your hand offends you, cut it off."

Is He talking about flesh? What is pride? The opposite of pure humility, which is one thousand percent teachable, is pride, which is arrogance and non-teachability. That is flesh.

For example, a man got up on television for a generation and preached against the Holy Ghost. He said, "It is a fallacy. Speaking in tongues passed away with the apostles." Violently and vehemently, he debated men all his life.

Then one day a terminal disease came on him, and a servant of God came by, laid hands on him, and served the man healing. His whole life was transformed. He had to get up on television and say, "For forty years I have preached a lie from the pits of hell and spent my life putting people in

bondage."

If God had given him the choice, "Maim yourself physically. Cut your hand off," he would have chosen that rather than the pain this caused all the people in him. It was the same as cutting his hand off and going through the rest of his life. He had to bear the marks of that until his death.

Believe me, it is better to be totally teachable and received by one who is receiving you as Jesus Christ, not offending you, receiving you and teaching you because your mouth is wide open.

When I was born again, I would eat anything.

This chapter is starting to make sense to you. See how God got this over to me? I had passed over the chapter probably forty or fifty times. "Lord, I do not know. I get lost." But I got stuck right here with my hand offending me, cutting it off.

I said, "Jesus, are You sure You did not change the subject?"

Of course, He proved He did not when He went on to say, "Therefore, take heed that you offend not one of these little ones." He was actually telling you and me how to begin to deal with the problem. Cut it off.

I kept meditating the whole chapter, from one verse clear to the end, pouring over it and pouring over it. I would read past that verse, and the Spirit would try to get something over to me, and I would miss it.

The Holy Spirit was speaking to me: "I want you to examine within yourself in those three areas: quick to forgive, totally teachable, and all trusting. I want you to examine in yourself, at the same magnitude, anything in you that might offend a little one. Son, I want you to deal with it and cut it off at any cost."

Do I have to? No. The disciples asked Him a question: "We want to know who is the greatest in the kingdom of God." No, you do not have to be that way. He is just answering their question.

If I were not a spiritual hog, I would not even understand what He said.

Glory to God.

I know all you thought I could teach about was tongues. We will get into that a little later in these meditational sessions, the role tongues play besides quieting the mind and giving answers to problems. That is enough, is it not?

Why does praying in tongues give answers to my problems? Very simple: because you are praying the immediate mind of Christ over your situation.

That is why sometimes He will bring you to the problem in your thinking, and you are thinking, "Oh no, I am not going to think about that." No, He is bringing you to the problem not to meditate on it, but to give you the answer.

He did not call you to run from your problems. He calls you to stand up to them and whip them. Denying that they exist is not faith. Going after the answer contained within the Word of God, with every biblical principle you know, is called faith.

Hallelujah.

The Good Shepherd's Priority Is That Not One Little One Be Lost

We need to take this a little further in this session. If you cannot understand all that I teach, thank God you have the tapes.

Let us go a little further. The eleventh verse says:

For the Son of man is come to save that which was lost.

What is His priority? If that is what He came for, then what kind of priority does He put on these little ones coming into the kingdom? He said, "This is the way you need to treat them, because this is the whole reason the Son of Man has come. He has come to save the lost, and He does not want you running them off."

Now I like this part:

How think ye?

Think about it. This is His way of saying, "Meditate on it." When He tells you to meditate on it, for God's sake, meditate on it. It is not very often Jesus asks your opinion. I have a chance to give Him the right one, and if I give Him the right one, it spells F-A-I-T-H.

Has the Word of God ever been so exciting?

He says:

How think ye? if a man have an hundred sheep, and one of them be gone astray, doth he not leave the ninety and nine, and goeth into the mountains, and seeketh that which is gone astray? And if so be that he find it, verily I say unto you, he rejoiceth more of that sheep, than of the ninety and nine which went not astray. Even so it is not the will of your Father which is in heaven, that one of these little ones should perish.

What are one hundred sheep? Believers. If a man has one hundred believers, sheep, they belong to the fold. One goes astray. Does he not leave the ninety-nine and seek after that one little one which went astray?

He says, "What do you think? What is My will?" Even so, it is not the will of your Father in heaven that one single one of these little ones be lost.

My God, if that is not His will, then that is His priority.

When I, by the Spirit, lend myself to the conformity of the nature of one of these little ones, then my priority will also be that not one of these little ones be lost. That will cause me to be a great one in the kingdom of God, and I will have all the tools of servitude I need to see that they are not.

If somebody receives one of these little ones to an offense and runs him off, Jesus says, "What do you think? Does not the Shepherd of the flock go after that little one at all cost, more so than the ninety-nine that went not astray? If He carries him back on His shoulders, do they not rejoice over him more than the established ninety-nine?"

He is saying, "If a little one goes astray, this is My will: I rejoice in his return."

So now He is switching the thrust of His message. The first part said you and I should not offend. We should become as one of these little ones, and at no cost offend. Get rid of all of it. Cut it off.

However, if a little one does go astray, if he is lost, then He gave you His will on that. The next progression we have missed because we have always changed the subject. The next progression is that if one little one is lost, He gives you the steps to his recovery.

This is where we have missed the context of Jesus' message. King James put in headings that make it look like Jesus changed the subject. No, He has not changed the subject. He says, "What do you think My will is? Think about it."

In verse 15 He says, "Moreover." In other words, on the foundation of what I have already laid, we are going to lay on that now. Now we are talking about that little one who went astray and the rejoicing done over his recovery. Now He is going to give the steps of the little one's recovery.

Are you strong? You want faith? This is actually a high-priority faith message.

"But I would rather hear the three steps to answered prayer."

This is a high-priority faith message.

When I found out through meditation, by not changing the subject, that Jesus was dealing with the return of that little sheep, it put a whole different meaning on these verses that we have taken for granted.

Recovering a Little One Begins Privately Instead of Creating Agreement Against Him

He said:

Moreover if thy brother shall trespass against thee, go and tell him his fault between thee and him alone: if he shall hear thee, thou hast gained thy brother.

If he hears you, you have regained your little sheep.

How do people act just after being born again? I know how I walked when I was first born again. My temper did not disappear. A lot of things about me did not disappear. It took me a while to conform as that teachable little child. I was totally at the mercy of my teachers because I believed everything they said, but I had flesh aspects about me.

"You do not go to our church? I will just slap the fat out of your face."

We would get in a big fight over it. We have all been there.

So if we were choosing who is the mature one and who is the little one in this confrontation, which one would it be? If your brother trespasses against you, who would be making the trespass? In reality, it would be that little one, in the context of this verse, that He is trying to regain.

If you are really mature in God, you will not trespass against somebody. You will not do it.

So He says, if you have a fault or an ought between you and your brother, the first step in the progression of that little one's return is to go to him and tell him his fault between him and you alone. If he hears you and restitution can be made, thank God, you have regained the little sheep back into the fold that went astray.

The reason He said go to him alone is because of how we usually act.

How many of you have a best friend?

"Well, did you know what Suzy Q did to me?"

"No. What?"

"Sister Garbage Ears ripped me off for \$50,000."

"Really, Sister Blabbermouth?"

The first thing we do is run to somebody else and get them to agree with us. "Will you agree with me that she did me wrong?"

"Yes, I agree with you, you poor little thing."

How about a pity party?

God is not after your return. He is after the other one's return. You already have yourself on your mind: "My \$50,000."

You may cancel the productive life of a little one out of the kingdom for the rest of his life. So you get someone to agree with you, and you enter into agreement:

"They did me wrong. Anything else you can think about them?"

"Yeah, yeah."

When two or more enter into that kind of agreement, the devil is in your midst to carry your agreement out. He says, "Good. You just gave me authority to dominate that little one and you too."

If he hears you, that is good. But what if he does not? Thank God for the Word of God, because it gives you the next step.

Mature Witnesses and the Church Pursue Restoration, Then Prayer Looses the Lost Sheep

Step number two:

But if he will not hear thee, then take with thee one or two more, that in the mouth of two or three witnesses every word may be established.

Now what you do is go get two or three witnesses who are on the same mature level as you are. Then you take them with you to talk to this person. They are supposed to stand and judge what one did to the other, deem one or the other wrong, and counsel them, so that more than one is telling him what he did was wrong.

If He is truly after this little one who went astray, which I guarantee He is, then the Lord checked me. He told me in my spirit, and I could hear Him:

"Look. I said, go to him. If he will not hear you, take three witnesses. If he will not hear them, then get the counsel of the church. If he will not hear the church, I said, let him be unto thee as a heathen man and a publican. I did not say you be one unto him. He is determined to be one to you, so let him be one to you, because you have already taken all the steps in the natural for his return."

So He says, "He is going to treat you like one, so let him treat you like one."

"All right, but how about my \$50,000?"

I still had myself on my hands, and I did not realize what God was saying until the next verse. I said, "How about my \$50,000?"

He said, "Thank God for step four."

Step four reads:

Verily I say unto you, Whatsoever ye shall bind on earth shall be bound in heaven: and whatsoever ye shall loose on earth shall be loosed in heaven.

If that was not enough, He says:

Again I say unto you, That if two of you shall agree on earth as touching any thing that they shall ask, it shall be done for them of My Father which is in heaven. For where two or three are gathered together in My name, there am I in the midst of them.

Where did the two or three people come in? I will tell you where they came in. These two or three people were in it almost from the beginning. Who in the world do you think He was talking about when He said, "Go get mature witnesses and call them in to judge and weigh every word"?

They are in it from the beginning. They know the man's problem. You go get them in legal agreement with you. Jesus says, "I will get in your midst on the legal agreement. When you draw this thing up and you cancel the man's debt, I am there in the midst of all of you and these witnesses in this legal agreement. These witnesses signed this legal agreement in the Spirit. I am in your midst. He will be loosed, and I will bind the devil out of his life, and I will return him to the fold. For I, Jesus, personally will go after him and bring him back."

Oh, hallelujah.